A Memory Like Home

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A Memory Like Home

by evasmlp

Summary

After months on Earth, Peter Quill is startled to see a familiar silhouette at the end of his driveway.
As Gamora steps into the light, memories in her eyes, she closes the distance without a word.
She runs into his arms, and their long lost love reignites with an unrestrained kiss.

Peter Quill had learned a few things about Earth since he came back.

First, people here had an endless number of TV channels, all showing basically the same three things: food competitions, murder documentaries, and awkward dating shows. Second, coffee was cheaper than in most parts of the galaxy but somehow, *worse*. And third, mornings were quiet. Too quiet.

He'd been living with his grandpa in a little house on the edge of a small town in Missouri. Out here, the loudest thing you heard before noon was the squeal of a bicycle brake or the occasional bark of a neighbor's dog.

No starship hum.
No Rocket tinkering in the background.
No Drax shouting about some metaphor he didn't understand.

And no Gamora.

Peter sat at the kitchen table, nursing a mug of coffee that was already lukewarm. It was the kind of morning that made you feel like you'd been left behind by the whole world the sun barely high enough to burn the dew off the grass, air so still you could hear the creak of the porch as the wood expanded in the heat.

He tried not to think about her. Really, he did.

But Gamora had a way of slipping in, even when he was trying to count the number of shingles missing from the neighbor's roof, or guessing how many more times his grandpa's cat could puke in the hallway before Peter lost his mind.

The worst part wasn't the missing. It was the knowing she was *out there*. Alive. Healthy. Breathing the same air somewhere far away. Just… not with him.

The Gamora he loved the one who'd shared that ridiculous dance on Xandar, who'd softened just enough to let him in she was gone. In her place was someone who wore her face but didn't know him. Didn't *want* to know him.

He'd told himself, over and over, that he had to respect that.
And mostly, he had.

Mostly.

Peter sighed, got up, and rinsed his mug in the sink. The glass rattled in the old pipes as the water ran another thing about Earth, apparently: everything made more noise than it should.

That's when he saw it.

A shadow at the far edge of the driveway.

At first, he thought maybe it was the neighbor's kid waiting for the school bus, or a delivery person who'd gotten the wrong address. But no the stance was different. Still. Upright. Balanced in a way that made his stomach twist.

The morning sun was in his eyes, forcing him to squint. The figure stood in that kind of light that turns everything into a cut out: no detail, just an outline against a gold wash of sky.

Something in his chest tightened.

No. Couldn't be.

He leaned forward, one hand braced on the sink.
The silhouette didn't move for a long beat. Then a slow step forward.

Peter's breath caught. His mind tried to get ahead of what he was seeing, to prepare him for the letdown. It was probably just someone passing by. Maybe a woman from down the street who happened to be the exact same height, the exact same build

The breeze shifted.

And in that movement, a few strands of hair caught the light dark, with the faintest green shimmer. His chest gave an involuntary lurch.

It couldn't be.
It was.

Gamora.

The mug slipped in the sink and clattered against the porcelain. He didn't hear it land because his ears were full of his own pulse.

His first instinct was to run outside but he didn't. Instead, he froze, eyes locked on her. She was closer now, her walk steady but unhurried, the set of her shoulders familiar in a way that stabbed at something deep inside him.

And then he saw her face.

Not the guarded, narrowed eyed look she'd given him the last time they met. Not the faint smirk she used to wear when she pretended she didn't like his jokes.

No there was something in her eyes now. Something warm.
Something *dangerously* close to recognition.

Peter felt like he was standing on the edge of a cliff. His heart was already over the side, falling fast, but his brain still hadn't caught up.

He did the only thing he knew how to do when his emotions started racing faster than his common sense.
He opened his mouth and cracked a joke.

“Hey, uh…” He stepped onto the porch, raising a hand like they were old friends running into each other at the grocery store. “You’re not here to rob me, right? ’Cause I’m fresh out of”

He didn’t get to finish.

Gamora moved.

It wasn’t a walk anymore; it was a run sudden, sharp, and sure. The space between them vanished in seconds, and before Peter could take another breath, she was right in front of him.

And then she was *on him*.

Her arms locked around his middle with the kind of force that would’ve knocked him over if she weren’t bracing him. His own arms, stunned into inaction, hung in the air for a beat before instinct took over and wrapped around her.

She was real. Solid. Warm. Her hair smelled faintly like something herbal and sharp, a scent that had been buried so deep in his memory he thought he’d imagined it.

Peter swallowed hard, trying to find words.
“What”

But she didn’t give him the chance.

Gamora tilted her head back just enough to meet his eyes. And then she kissed him.

It wasn’t careful, wasn’t slow, wasn’t the tentative press of someone testing boundaries. This was *all in*. A rush of everything they’d lost, everything they’d almost said, everything they’d run out of time for all packed into a single, breath stealing instant.

Peter’s hand found her cheek, his thumb brushing against her jaw. He felt her fingers curl into the collar of his jacket like she was afraid he might pull away. He didn’t. Couldn’t.

The world narrowed to the warmth of her mouth, the pressure of her hold, the racing beat of his own heart against hers.

Somewhere far away, a car passed. The neighbor’s dog barked. The sun climbed another inch in the sky. But none of it mattered.

For the first time in years since Titan, since ***before*** the universe felt right again.

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